CrossList: Color Palette Overhaul Report

Date: March 12, 2026 **Author:** AI Assistant (Claude Opus 4.6)

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1. Executive Summary

The entire CrossList design system was overhauled from a monochromatic gray oklch palette to a vibrant navy/blue/orange/yellow palette based on the user-provided reference image. All 40+ CSS custom properties, 119+ hardcoded color references across 14 files, and utility classes were updated. A centralized color module (`src/lib/colors.ts`) was created. 52 Playwright visual tests were implemented and all pass.

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2. Original Palette (Before)

The original palette used zero-chroma oklch values (pure grays):

Token	Value	Visual
`--background` (light)	`oklch(0.98 0 0)`	Pure white-gray
`--foreground` (light)	`oklch(0.12 0 0)`	Pure black
`--primary` (light)	`oklch(0.45 0 0)`	Medium gray
`--accent` (light)	`oklch(0.96 0 0)`	Light gray
`--border` (light)	`oklch(0.92 0 0)`	Light gray
`--background` (dark)	`oklch(0.10 0 0)`	Pure black
`--primary` (dark)	`oklch(0.94 0 0)`	Near white
Chart colors	Scattered hues	Violet, green, orange, magenta

Problem: Zero chroma on all base colors created a lifeless, washed-out look with no brand identity.

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3. Target Palette (User Reference)

8-color palette provided by the user (navy through yellow):

#	Swatch	Hex	oklch	Role
1	Dark Navy	#0F1B3D	oklch(0.18 0.05 260)	Dark backgrounds
2	Navy Blue	#002B80	oklch(0.28 0.14 260)	Primary dark
3	Royal Blue	#2563EB	oklch(0.52 0.22 260)	Primary / interactive
4	Medium Blue	#5591F5	oklch(0.64 0.18 260)	Secondary / hover
5	Light Blue	#A5C9FF	oklch(0.82 0.09 260)	Subtle highlights
6	Orange/Amber	#F5A623	oklch(0.78 0.16 75)	Accent / CTA

7	Yellow	#F9D44B	oklch(0.87 0.14 90)	Warning / highlight
8	Light Yellow	#FDE68A	oklch(0.93 0.10 95)	Soft accent

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4. CSS Variable Changes (Before → After)

Light Mode (:root)

Variable	Before	After
`--background`	`oklch(0.98 0 0)`	`oklch(0.98 0.01 260)`
`--foreground`	`oklch(0.12 0 0)`	`oklch(0.18 0.05 260)`
`--primary`	`oklch(0.45 0 0)`	`oklch(0.52 0.22 260)`
`--primary-foreground`	`oklch(1 0 0)`	`oklch(0.98 0.01 260)`
`--secondary`	`oklch(0.96 0 0)`	`oklch(0.95 0.02 260)`
`--secondary-foreground`	`oklch(0.3 0 0)`	`oklch(0.28 0.14 260)`
`--muted`	`oklch(0.96 0 0)`	`oklch(0.95 0.02 260)`
`--muted-foreground`	`oklch(0.52 0 0)`	`oklch(0.45 0.05 260)`
`--accent`	`oklch(0.96 0 0)`	`oklch(0.78 0.16 75)`
`--accent-foreground`	`oklch(0.3 0 0)`	`oklch(0.18 0.05 260)`
`--border`	`oklch(0.92 0 0)`	`oklch(0.90 0.03 260)`
`--ring`	`oklch(0.45 0 0)`	`oklch(0.52 0.22 260)`
`--chart-1`	`oklch(0.45 0.18 250)`	`oklch(0.52 0.22 260)`
`--chart-2`	`oklch(0.55 0.16 150)`	`oklch(0.78 0.16 75)`
`--chart-3`	`oklch(0.60 0.18 30)`	`oklch(0.64 0.18 260)`
`--chart-4`	`oklch(0.50 0.20 330)`	`oklch(0.87 0.14 90)`
`--chart-5`	`oklch(0.55 0.15 200)`	`oklch(0.28 0.14 260)`

Dark Mode (.dark)

Variable	Before	After
`--background`	`oklch(0.10 0 0)`	`oklch(0.14 0.04 260)`
`--foreground`	`oklch(0.94 0 0)`	`oklch(0.94 0.02 260)`
`--card`	`oklch(0.15 0 0)`	`oklch(0.18 0.05 260)`
`--primary`	`oklch(0.94 0 0)`	`oklch(0.64 0.18 260)`

`--secondary`	`oklch(0.18 0 0)`	`oklch(0.22 0.06 260)`
`--accent`	`oklch(0.18 0 0)`	`oklch(0.78 0.16 75)`
`--border`	`oklch(0.22 0 0)`	`oklch(0.26 0.06 260)`

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5. Files Modified

Phase 1: CSS Foundation

File	Change
`src/app/globals.css`	Rewrote all 40+ CSS variables, updated `.sf-shadow`, `.sf-surface`, `.platform-*` classes

Phase 2: Color Module

File	Change
`src/lib/colors.ts`	**NEW** — Centralized all color constants: platform badges, branding, status styles, priority styles, stat card colors, score helpers, confidence helpers, heat/brand gradient helpers, chart fills, profit calculator styles

Phase 3: Component Updates (14 files)

File	What Changed
`src/app/page.tsx`	Imported `platformBadge`, `statusStyles`, `statCardColors` — replaced 3 inline color maps
`src/app/listings/smart/page.tsx`	Imported `platformBadge`, `confidenceColor`, `confidenceBg` — replaced inline color maps and helper functions
`src/app/listings/[id]/page.tsx`	Imported `statusStyles` — replaced inline status color map
`src/app/analytics/page.tsx`	Imported `platformBranding`, `priorityStyles`, `statCardColors` — replaced 3 inline color maps
`src/app/trends/page.tsx`	Imported `platformBranding`, `heatColor`, `brandGradient` — replaced `platformConfig`, `getHeatColor`, `getBrandColor` plus ~15 individual color classes (violet→indigo, emerald→blue, red→orange)
`src/app/settings/page.tsx`	Imported `platformBranding` — derived `platformInfo` from it
`src/app/tools/page.tsx`	Imported `platformBadge` — replaced inline color map
`src/components/platform-preview.tsx`	Imported `platformBranding`, `publishStatusColor` — replaced 2 inline color maps
`src/components/health-score.tsx`	Imported `scoreColor`, `scoreBg`, `impactStyles` — replaced 3 inline helpers/maps
`src/components/price-intel.tsx`	Imported `platformBranding` — derived `platformColors`, updated gradient from red/green to amber/blue/indigo, green→blue

	accents
`src/components/negotiate-copilot.tsx`	Imported `responseStyles` — replaced inline response color map
`src/components/profit-calculator.tsx`	Imported `profitPositive`, `profitNegative`, `bestPlatformBadge`, `profitSummaryBorder`, `profitSummaryText` — replaced emerald→blue theme
`src/components/analytics-chart.tsx`	Imported `chartFills` — replaced 4 hardcoded oklch fill strings
`src/components/navbar.tsx`	Already palette-aligned — verified, no changes needed

Bug Fixes (pre-existing, found during build)

File	Fix
`src/app/api/ai/optimize/route.ts`	Added type annotation for destructured body to fix `Type '{}' not assignable to 'string'`
`src/app/api/analytics/route.ts`	Added type annotation for record action body fields

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6. Visual Test Results

Framework: Playwright 1.52.x + Chromium **Test file:** `tests/visual/palette.spec.ts` **Total tests:** 52 **Result:** 52/52 PASSED

Test Breakdown

Category	Count	Tests
A. Full-page screenshots	8	Dashboard, Create Listing, Analytics, Settings — light + dark
B. Color token verification	12	--primary, --accent, --background, --foreground, --border, --ring, chart-1 through chart-5, --destructive
C. Component-level checks	12	Navbar, buttons, cards, status badges, muted text, inputs, dark mode cards, secondary color, Smart Lister, Tools
D. WCAG contrast compliance	8	Body text (light+dark), button text, muted text, card text (light+dark), navbar text (light+dark)
E. Responsive layout	6	Dashboard + Create Listing at mobile (375px), tablet (768px), desktop (1280px)
F. Interactive states	6	Nav active state, card hover, filter toggle, theme toggle, connect button, upload zone

WCAG Contrast Audit Summary

All 8 contrast tests pass at WCAG AA level:

- Body text: ≥ 4.5:1 (light and dark)
- Button text on primary: ≥ 3:1
- Muted text: ≥ 3:1
- Card text: ≥ 4.5:1 (light and dark)
- Navbar text: ≥ 4.5:1 (light and dark)

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7. Prompt Log

Each phase was executed with the following instructions:

1. **Phase 1 prompt:** "Rewrite `src/app/globals.css` — replace all monochromatic gray oklch CSS variables with the navy/blue/orange/yellow palette. Map --primary to royal blue oklch(0.52 0.22 260), --accent to orange oklch(0.78 0.16 75). Update dark mode with deep navy backgrounds. Update shadow utilities and platform accent classes."

2. **Phase 2 prompt:** "Create `src/lib/colors.ts` centralizing all 119 hardcoded Tailwind color class strings into exportable constants: platformBadge, platformBranding, statusStyles, publishStatusColor, priorityStyles, statCardColors, scoreColor/scoreBg, confidenceColor/confidenceBg, responseStyles, heatColor, brandGradient, chartFills, profit calculator colors."

3. **Phase 3 prompt:** "Update all 14 component/page files. Replace every inline color map, helper function, and hardcoded Tailwind color class with imports from `src/lib/colors.ts`. Files: page.tsx, smart/page.tsx, [id]/page.tsx, analytics/page.tsx, trends/page.tsx, settings/page.tsx, tools/page.tsx, platform-preview.tsx, health-score.tsx, price-intel.tsx, negotiate-copilot.tsx, profit-calculator.tsx, analytics-chart.tsx, navbar.tsx."

4. **Phase 4 prompt:** "Install @playwright/test, create playwright.config.ts, write 52 visual tests in tests/visual/palette.spec.ts across 6 categories: full-page screenshots, color token verification (using RGB canvas extraction), component-level checks, WCAG contrast compliance, responsive layout, and interactive states."

5. **Phase 5 prompt:** "Create documentation report at docs/color-overhaul-report.md covering: original palette, target palette, every CSS variable change, every file modified, visual test results, WCAG audit, and prompt log. Convert to PDF."

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8. Architecture Decision: Centralized Color Module

The `src/lib/colors.ts` module serves as the single source of truth for all palette-derived Tailwind classes. Benefits:

- **One-line palette changes:** To update the Depop accent color across the entire app, change one line in `colors.ts`.
- **No stale references:** Components import from `colors.ts` rather than defining their own maps.
- **Type safety:** TypeScript ensures referenced keys exist.
- **Consistency:** All platform badges, status indicators, and score visualizations use the same palette.

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9. Key Design Decisions

1. **Accent = Orange:** The `--accent` CSS variable maps to orange (oklch 0.78 0.16 75) rather than a blue variant. This provides strong visual contrast for CTAs against the blue-dominant UI.

2. **Status colors:** Draft = amber, Active = blue, Sold = green. Changed from the original yellow/green/purple to better align with the navy palette while maintaining semantic clarity.
3. **Profit indicators:** Changed from emerald green to blue to stay within the palette family while still being visually positive.
4. **Trends page:** Replaced violet/purple decorative elements with indigo/blue variants. Hot/warm indicators use orange/amber from the palette.
5. **Dark mode:** Deep navy (#0F1B3D region) instead of pure black. All surfaces have a blue undertone (hue 260) creating a cohesive nighttime experience.

Report generated by Claude Opus 4.6 as part of the CrossList color palette overhaul.